Turning 18: What Changes — Speaker Notes

Friday, December 11, 2026 · 6:30–7:15 PM CT · Live on Zoom. Teaching runs about 35 minutes (slides in order), then questions to minute 45. Read the notes in your own words — they are a guide, not a script.

Slide 1 — Title / Welcome

[Minutes 0–2] Welcome everyone. Tonight is for families whose teen turns 18 in 2027 — or soon after. Turning 18 changes the rules in big ways, and starting early makes all of it smoother. No cost, no sales pitch. Questions at the end; registered questions first.

Slide 2 — Tonight's Road Map

[Minutes 2–3] Read the road map. Tell them the papers slide is the one to photograph.

Slide 3 — Why 18 Changes Everything

[Minutes 3–6] Set the stage calmly. This is not scary — it is a change to be ready for, and ready is exactly what tonight does.

Slide 4 — The Money Change

[Minutes 6–10] This is the fact families miss most: a no at 15 can become a yes at 18. Never promise a result — SSA decides. But every family with a 17-year-old should ask the question fresh at 18.

Slide 5 — The Age-18 Review

[Minutes 10–14] The review is normal and expected — not a punishment. Strong records are the best preparation. Tell families: this year, papers are gold.

Slide 6 — DAC: The Benefit Most Families Miss

[Minutes 14–19] DAC is the benefit almost nobody is told about. And the warning matters: when a parent is about to file, talk to us first — filing order can protect the young adult's Medicaid. Never promise amounts.

Slide 7 — Decisions at 18: Who Signs, Who Chooses

[Minutes 19–23] Handle with care. Many families have never heard they have choices here. Our role: explain the questions, help gather the picture, and point them to a Texas attorney for the legal step. Never give legal advice.

Slide 8 — School at 18

[Minutes 23–26] Short and practical. The school piece surprises families — suddenly letters come addressed to the student. A written request keeps parents in the loop where the school allows.

Slide 9 — The Papers to Gather Over the Holidays

[Minutes 26–30] Read the list slowly — photo-the-slide moment. The holidays are the perfect time: one folder, five things, done before January.

Slide 10 — Start Early: The January Steps

[Minutes 30–33] End teaching with action. Every family's dates differ — that is what the free talk sorts out.

Slide 11 — One Small Step This Week

[Minutes 33–35] Small and doable. Then questions.

Slide 12 — Questions

[Minutes 35–45] Registered questions first. Keep answers general in the group; family dates and details belong in the free talk.

Slide 13 — Thank You — and Merry Christmas!

[Close] Wish them a Merry Christmas and a calm start to 2027. We will be here in January when the steps start.